
”From Bibliography to Network: Mapping the Contemporary Field of Leigh Hunt Studies (1987–2025)”

Michael Sinatra^{*1}, Anton Boudreau Ninkov^{*1}, and Kim Martin^{*2}

¹Université de Montréal (UdeM) – Canada

²University of Guelph – Canada

Abstract

This short paper presents work in progress that treats a curated bibliography of Leigh Hunt scholarship not only as a research aid, but as a historical source that records how a field is assembled through venues, institutions, and thematic emphases. Drawing on 364 bibliographic records (1987–2025) representing 304 authors, 124 journals, and 177 institutional affiliations, we ask three linked questions: (1) which publication venues and institutional locations function as hubs in late-20th- and early-21st-century Hunt studies; (2) how have these hubs shifted across time; and (3) how do gaps in bibliographic metadata (e.g., missing affiliations/countries/tags) shape the networks we can responsibly claim from the source.

This bibliographic inquiry is framed by Hunt’s own exceptionally networked career. James Henry Leigh Hunt (1784–1859) was a central participant in British literary and political culture across the first half of the nineteenth century: editor of *The Examiner* from 1808 to 1822, leader of the so-called Cockney School of Poetry, associate of Percy Bysshe Shelley, Mary Shelley, Byron, Keats, Hazlitt, Lamb, and Dickens, and a radical journalist imprisoned for seditious libel against the Prince Regent in 1813. The larger project situates Hunt as the focus of a broader project to encode approximately 1,500 critical essays written between 1805 and 1859. This paper uses the critical bibliography as a smaller but revealing proxy for a larger scholarly problem: how the infrastructures of description, citation, affiliation, and disciplinary attention make Hunt legible as a Romantic, Victorian, political, periodical, and digital-humanities object of study.

Methodologically, we model the dataset as a set of interlocking bipartite graphs (author–journal; author–affiliation) and a tag co-occurrence network. Because “Networks and their Sources” foregrounds the incompleteness and bias of evidence, we treat data cleaning as interpretive labor: we normalize variant entity strings (e.g., journal-title inconsistencies) while preserving uncertainty by retaining missing values as explicit “Unknown” nodes rather than dropping records. We then compute basic centrality measures and compare time-sliced networks (pre-2010, 2010–2019, 2020–2025) to capture change over time and the consequences of patchy source description (Wasserman and Faust 1994).

Preliminary results indicate a pronounced concentration of Hunt-related work in a small set of journals (especially *Keats-Shelley Journal* and *The Byron Journal*) and a geographically uneven field dominated by US and UK affiliations, with smaller but coherent clusters in

*Speaker

Canada and parts of continental Europe. Tag co-occurrence highlights recurring emphases on Romanticism, politics, and religion, alongside subfields central to Hunt's reception (e.g., Cockney School debates, imprisonment, correspondence), contextualizing renewed attention to Hunt as cultural broker and radical journalist (Eberle-Sinatra 2005; Roe 2005). The paper helps clarify why missing affiliations, inconsistent venue names, and uneven topic assignment are not merely technical defects: they are evidence of how Hunt studies has been organized, institutionalized, and periodically rediscovered. Next steps include enriching records with cited-reference links (where available) to evaluate bibliographic-coupling approaches for thematic proximity beyond curator-assigned tags (Kessler 1963; Boyack and Klavans 2010).

References

Boyack, Kevin W., and Richard Klavans. 2010. "Co-Citation Analysis, Bibliographic Coupling, and Direct Citation: Which Citation Approach Represents the Research Front Most Accurately?" *Journal of the American Society for Information Science and Technology* 61 (12): 2389–2404.

Eberle-Sinatra, Michael. 2005. *Leigh Hunt and the London Literary Scene: A Reception History of his Major Works, 1805-1828*. London: Routledge.

Kessler, M. M. 1963. "Bibliographic Coupling Between Scientific Papers." *American Documentation* 14 (1): 10–25.

Roe, Nicholas. 2005. *Fiery Heart: The First Life of Leigh Hunt*. London: Pimlico.

Wasserman, Stanley, and Katherine Faust. 1994. *Social Network Analysis: Methods and Applications*. Cambridge: Cambridge UP

Keywords: Leigh Hunt, Network visualization, bibliographical records, digital humanities

From Bibliography to Network: Mapping the Contemporary Field of Leigh Hunt Studies (1987–2025)

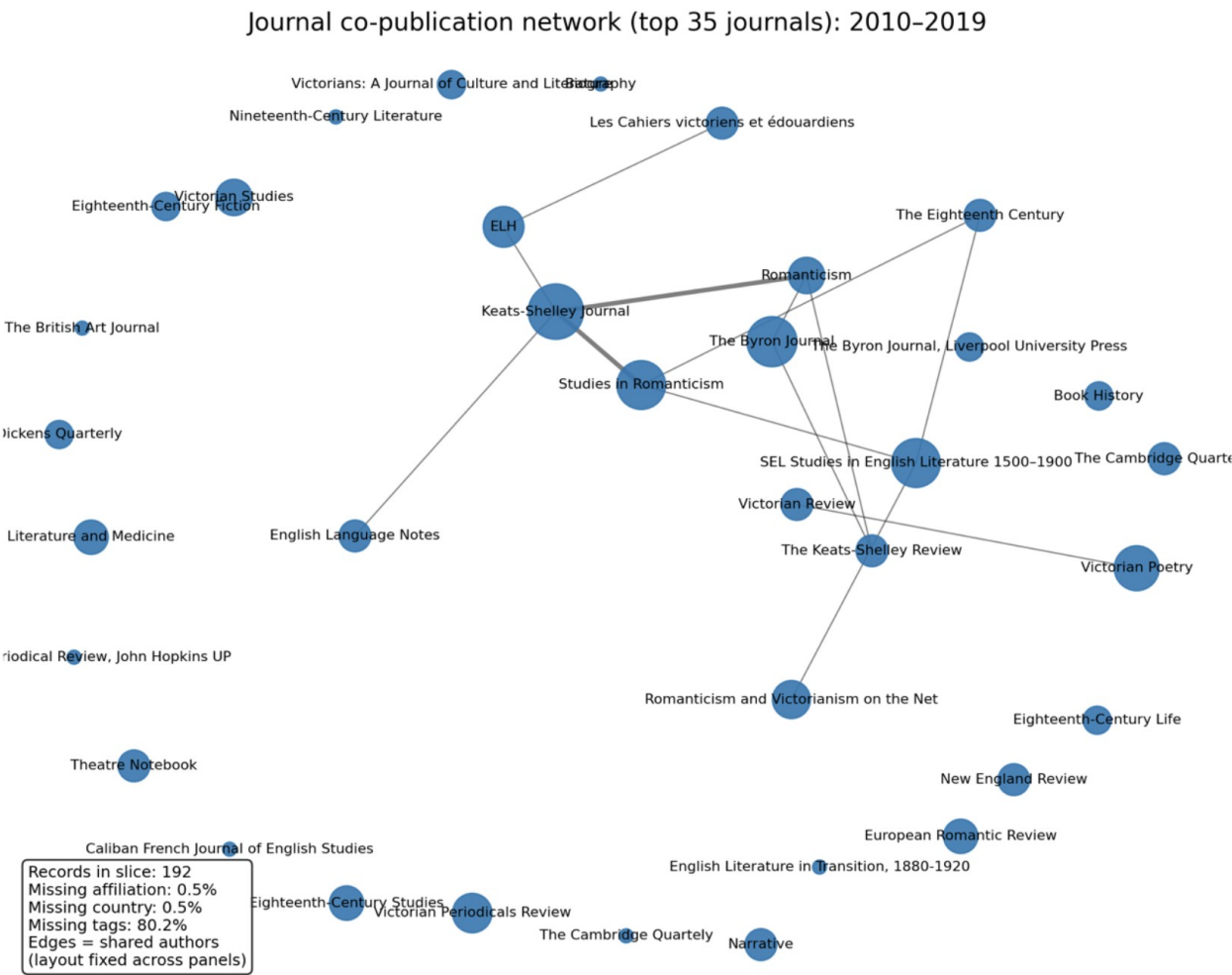


Figure 1. Journal co-publication networks derived from a curated bibliography of Leigh Hunt scholarship. Nodes are journals (size = number of records); edges indicate shared authors. This panel shows a time slice using a fixed layout to highlight shifting hubs and the effects of incomplete metadata.